Through the grind Chouhan joined the RSS when just 13, and after doing time in affiliate ABVP, rose to lead BJP youth outfit Bharatiya Janata Yuva Morcha (BJYM), even going to jail briefly during the Emergency

The political trail A gold medalist in M.A. Philosophy, he moved to the assembly and then the Lok Sabha in the early 1990s. After a decade and a half as an MP from Vidisha, he was appointed Madhya Pradesh CM in 2005. One of the BJP's most effective CMs, many considered him a competitor to Modi in 2014

On higher ground Chouhan's experience in turning MP into one of the top three agricultural states will stand him in good stead. Also, if his central stint works out, he may well fall into the succession line in the post-Modi era

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

Farmgate infra Work with states on 'farm gate' infrastructure to enable farmers to get best prices for produce along with pushing for reforms with the APMC (Agricultural Produce Market Committee) Act

eNAM Increase access to the National Agriculture Market or eNAM, the state's online trading platform for 176 agri commodities. Also, encourage more financial institutions to back e-receipts of warehouse-based commodities trading

GM crops Need to build consensus on its fate in India

MSP Farmers in the northern belt are pushing for a legal framework for MSP. Mono crop production has destroyed the fields and crop diversification is a must in this region. Farmers have to be convinced on this

JAL SHAKTI

REGAIN THE FLOW

The ambition is intact, but progress slow on the flagship Jal Jeevan and Namami Gange projects

By AMARNATH K. MENON

India has yet to leverage its Jal Shakti, despite the lavishing of funds and attention. Both the Jal Jeevan Mission—to provide piped water supply to all homes— and Namami Gange, to clean and desilt the river, are works in progress. What is encouraging is the launch of the E-flow Monitoring System, towards ensuring sustainable currents in the Ganga. Utilising data from quarterly reports by the Central Water Commission, it will track key parameters such as inflow, outflow and mandated E-flow across 11 projects along the Ganga. ■



ANI

C.R. PATIL *69* | BJP
Minister of Jal Shakti

Ministers of State

RAJ BHUSHAN CHOUDHARY, *46* | BJP

V. SOMANNA, *73* | BJP

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

Rejuvenating the Ganga Introduce monitoring and regulatory mechanisms on all major tributaries to safeguard the Ganga's ecology

Dig deep Rev up Mission Amrit Sarovar to rejuvenate 75 water bodies per district and create 50,000 new water bodies of an acre or more each

WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

EXPAND E-GOVERNANCE Digitising the rural landscape and promoting local e-governance can make our 650,000 villages and their 800 million-plus residents self-sufficient

EMPOWER WOMEN SHGS Scale up the Ladli Behana Yojana to train women in SHGs and help them generate a sustainable income of at least Rs 1 lakh annually. Help SHGs evolve from micro credit outfits to business entities in their own right

RURAL LIVELIHOOD Enlarge funding for the National Rural Livelihood Mission to address subsistence challenges. Improve resource efficiency in delivery of scheme benefits

SHIVRAJ SINGH CHOUHAN
Minister of Rural Development

Ministers of State

PEMMASANI CHANDRA SEKHAR, *48* | TDP
Guntur MP; also MoS, Communications

KAMLESH PASWAN, *47* | BJP
Four-time MP from Bansgaon, UP